

ON THE MOON, AS ON THE MOON



by VOLODYMYR VLADKO

1

IT WAS
FROZEN SOLID.
AND HEAVY.



2

JOHN!
WHERE ARE YOU,
JOHN?



3

LEAVE IT!
COME HERE NOW!



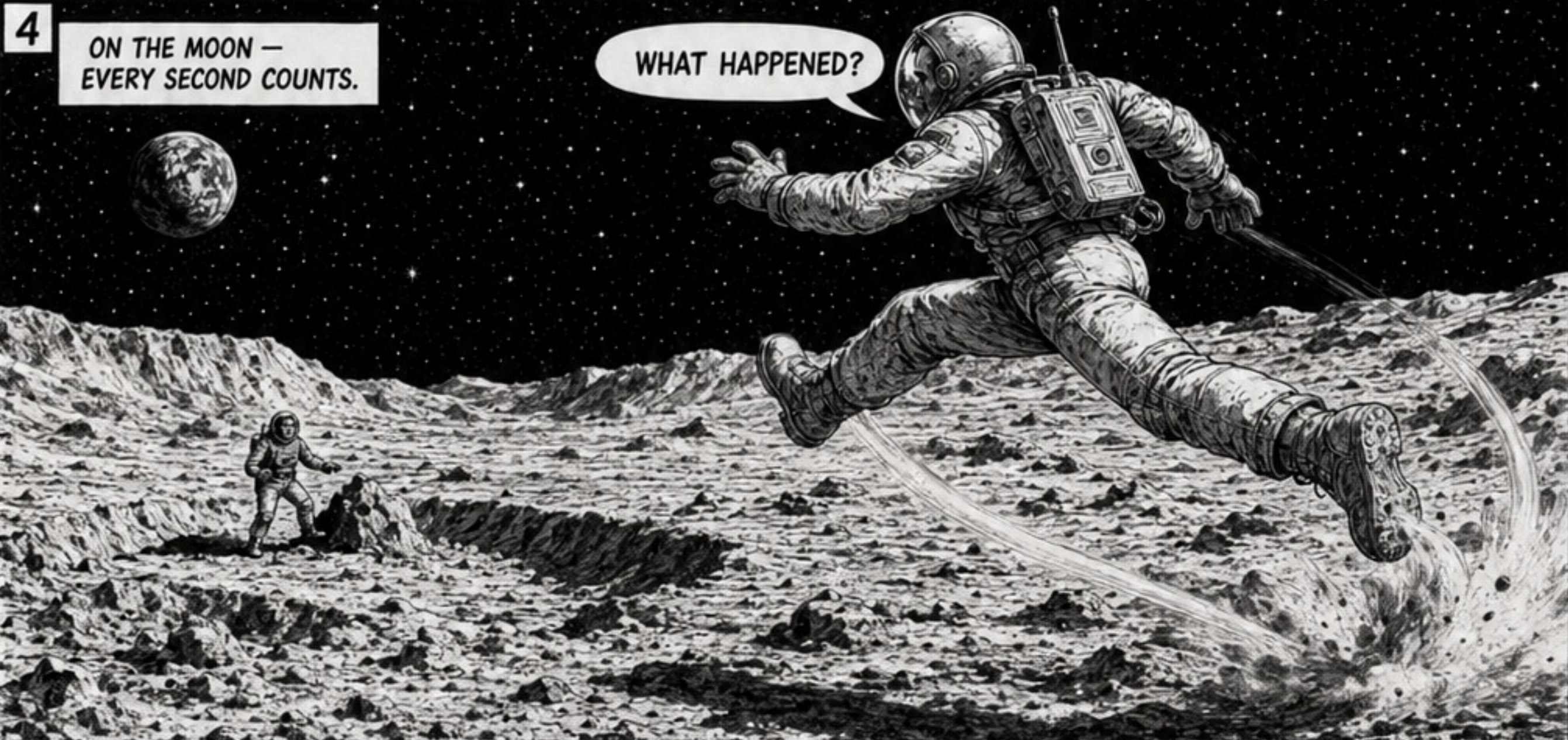
I'M HERE, BORYS!
FOUND TRACES OF ICE —
VERY INTERESTING!



4

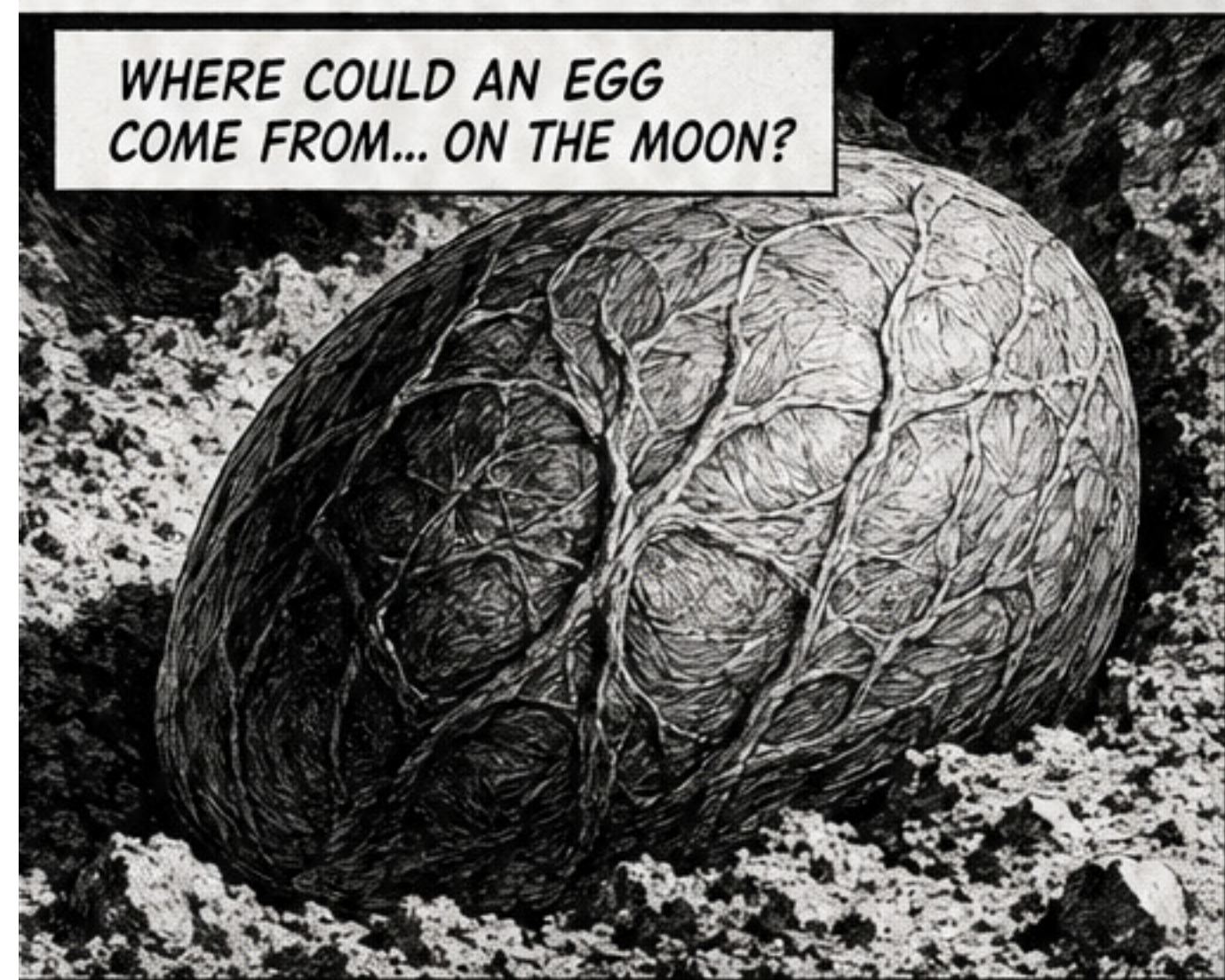
ON THE MOON —
EVERY SECOND COUNTS.

WHAT HAPPENED?





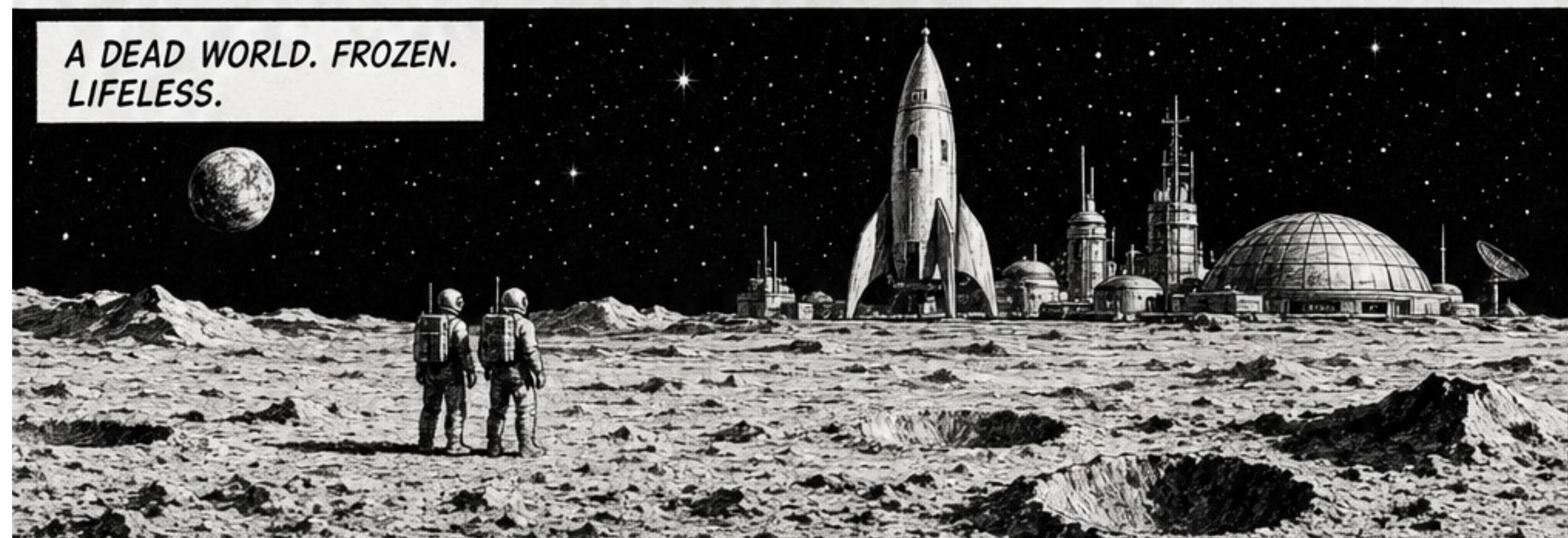
WHERE COULD AN EGG
COME FROM... ON THE MOON?



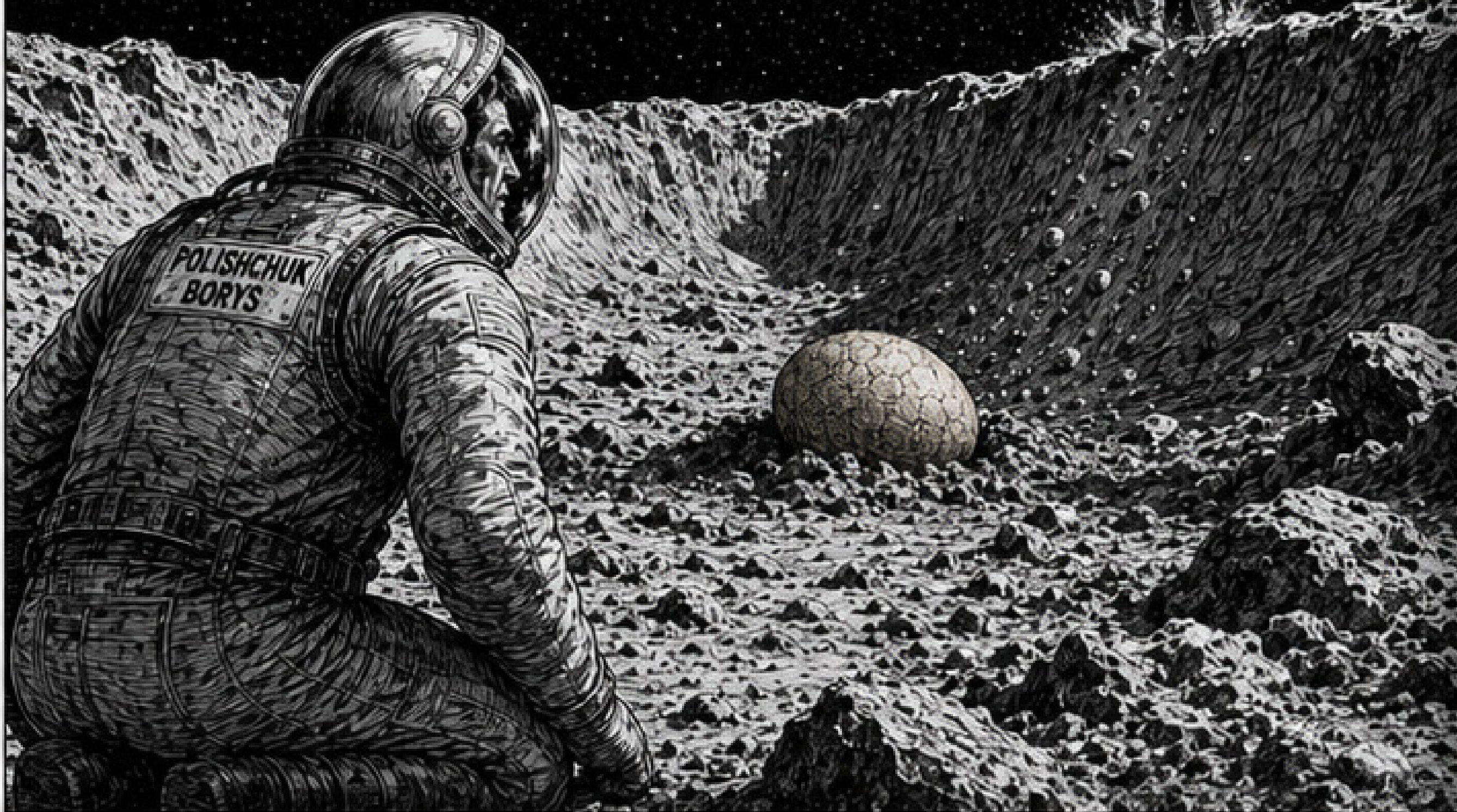
THIS IS... NOT
A ROCK.



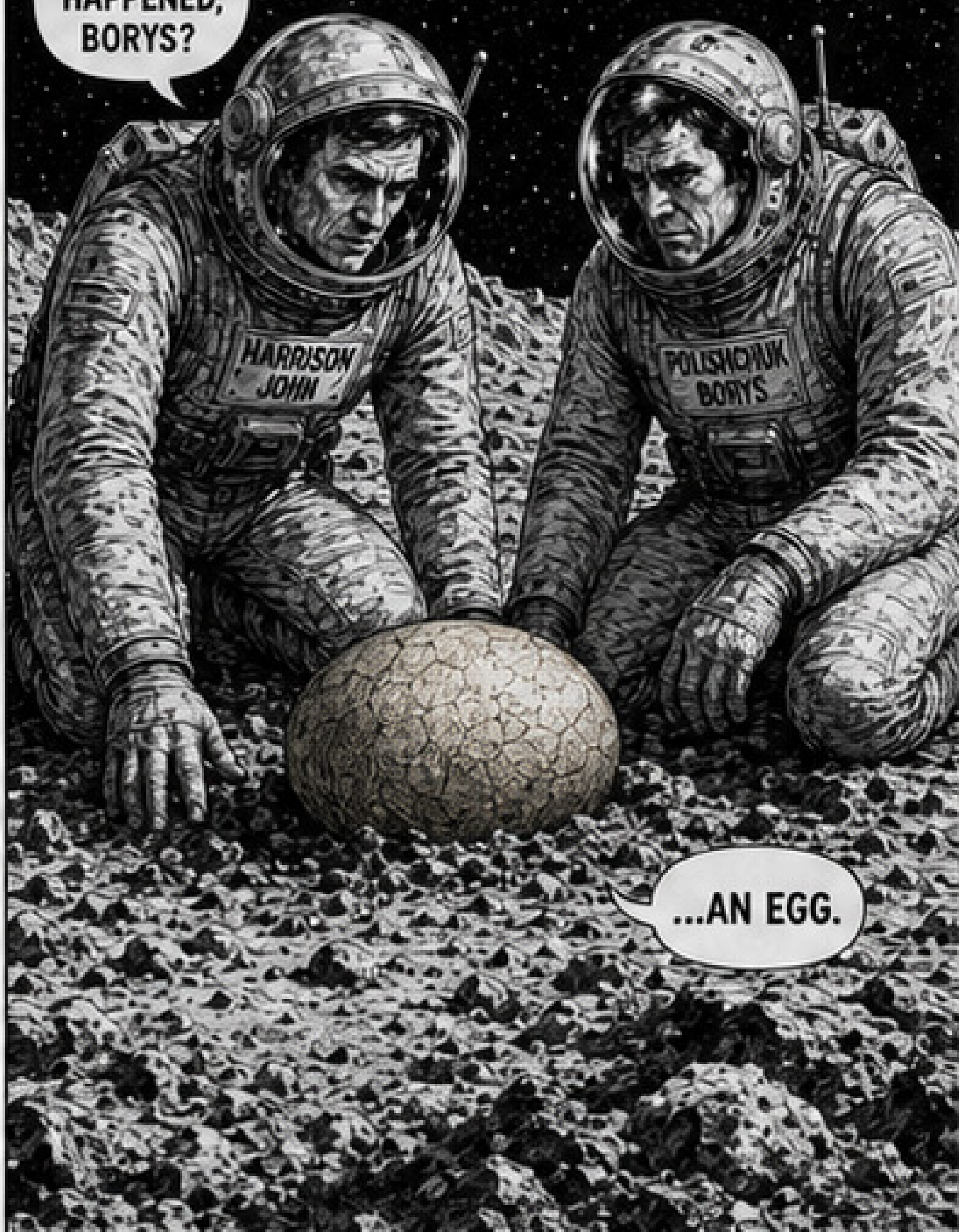
A DEAD WORLD. FROZEN.
LIFELESS.



ON THE MOON —
DISTANCES ARE
IMPOSSIBLE TO JUDGE.



SO WHAT
HAPPENED,
BORYS?



...AN EGG.

WHERE DID
IT COME
FROM?!





THEY KEPT DIGGING.

TWO...
THREE...
FOUR!

THAT'S IT,
BORYS. FIVE
EGGS TOTAL.

A NEST...
OR WHAT?

A COSMIC BIRD
FLEW OVER THE MOON
AND LEFT EGGS IN A
CRATER, RIGHT? AND
SOON IT WILL RETURN
TO HATCH THEM?

THE LONG LUNAR DAY
WAS ENDING.

THESE EGGS ARE A FACT.
UNEXPLAINED. IF THERE ARE
EGGS — THERE MAY BE A BIRD.
I AM READY FOR ANYTHING NOW.



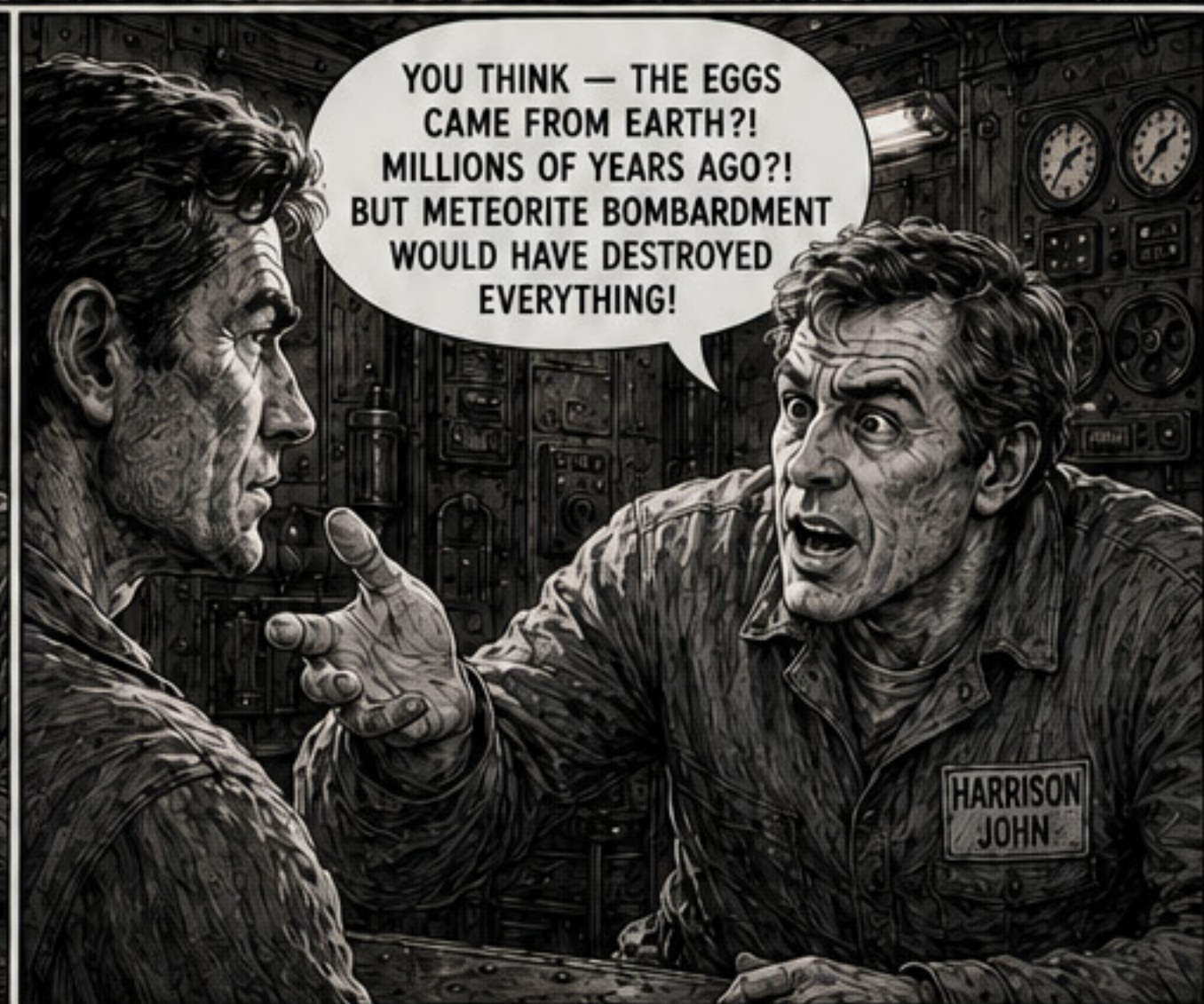
THE MOON ONCE BROKE AWAY FROM EARTH. MILLIONS OF YEARS AGO. A MASSIVE CHUNK — TORN OFF, SHAPED INTO A SPHERE BY GRAVITY, ORBITING EVER SINCE.

AN UNPROVEN HYPOTHESIS.



THIS ONLY PROVES COMMON ORIGIN — NOTHING MORE!

BUT THE MOON TORE AWAY WITH EVERYTHING THAT WAS ON THAT PIECE OF EARTH.



YOU THINK — THE EGGS CAME FROM EARTH?! MILLIONS OF YEARS AGO?! BUT METEORITE BOMBARDMENT WOULD HAVE DESTROYED EVERYTHING!



THEY WERE BURIED. SLOWLY EXPOSED OVER MILLIONS OF YEARS. FROZEN SOLID — PERFECTLY PRESERVED.

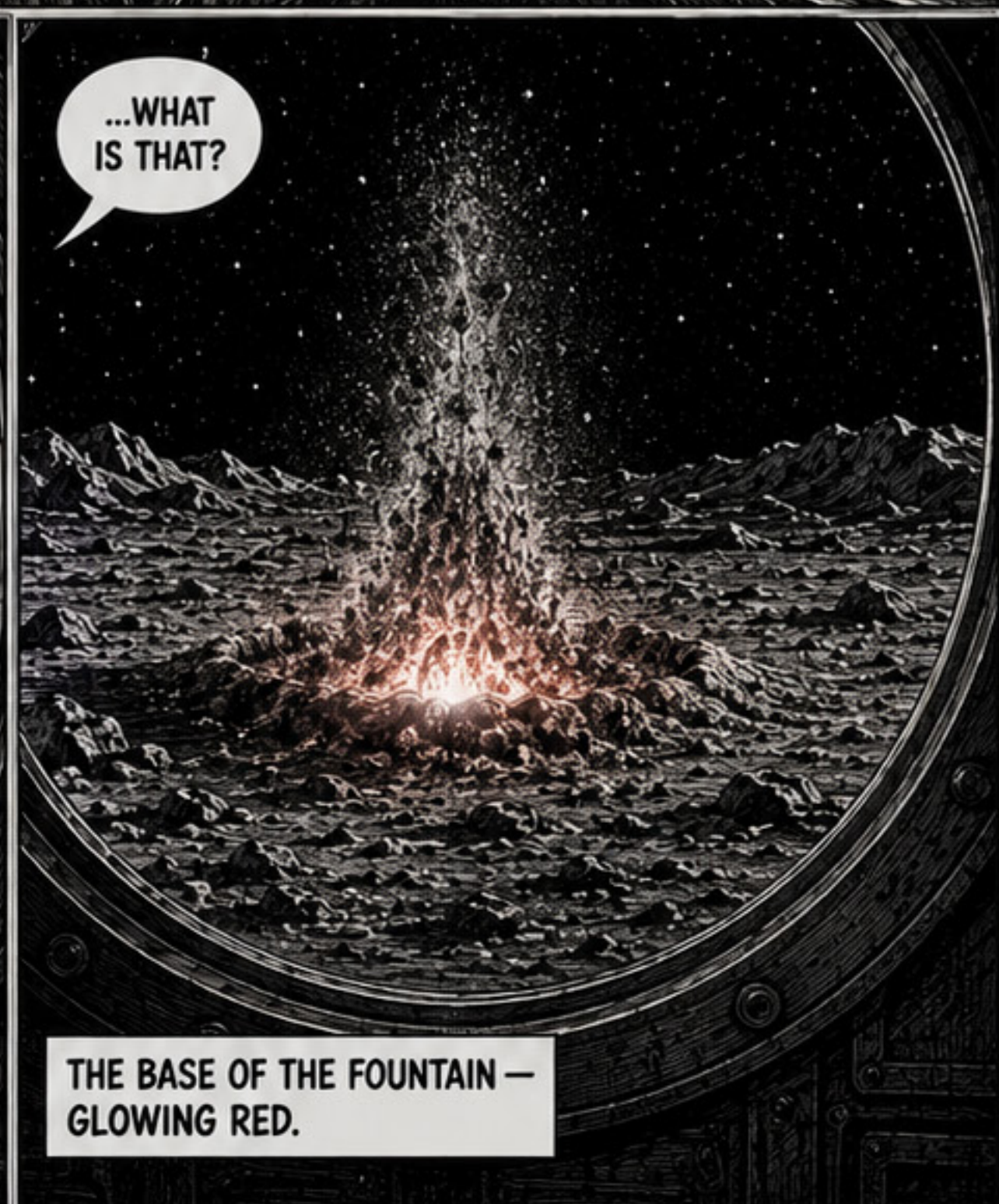
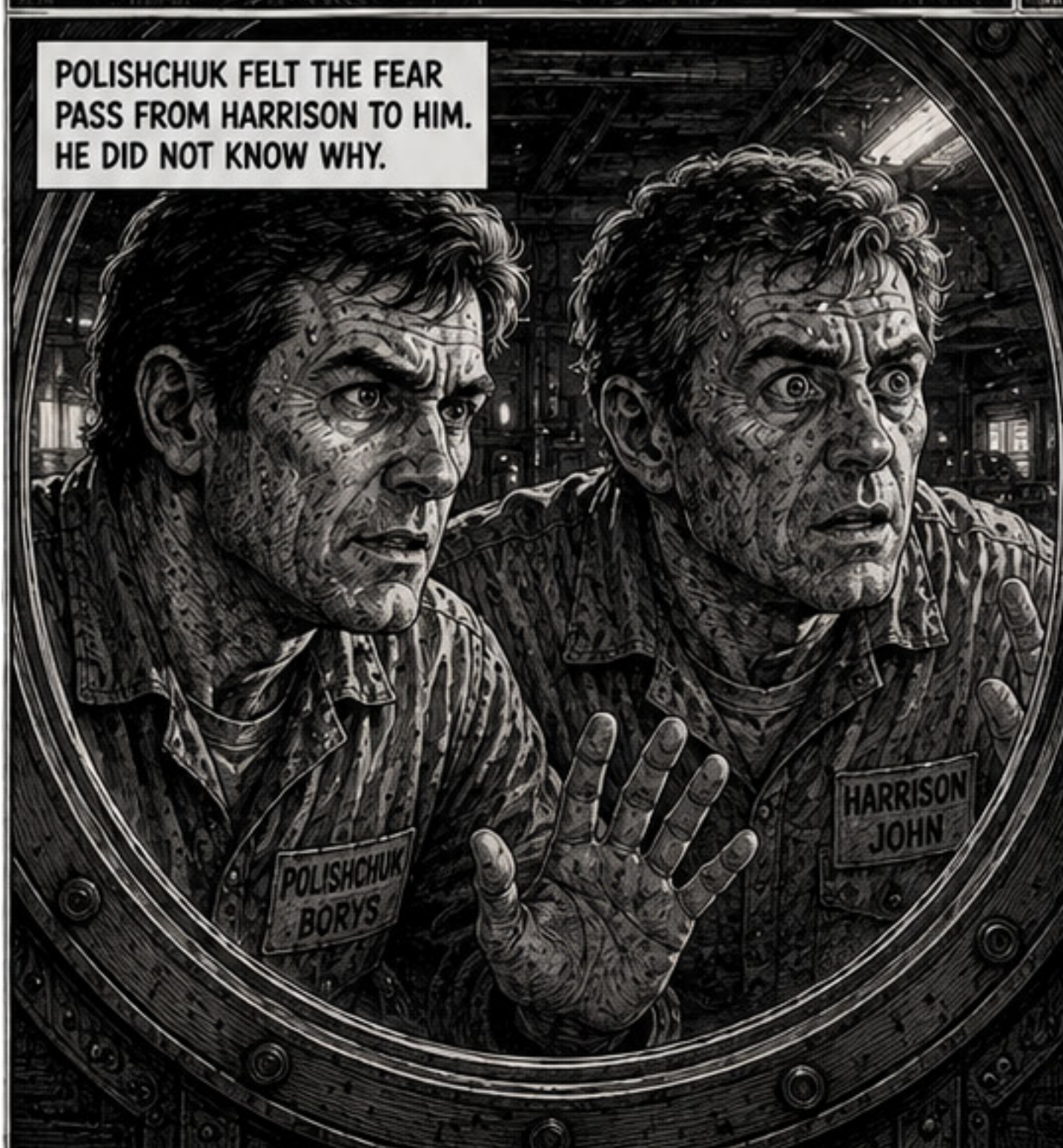
...



BUT WHAT KIND OF CREATURE LAID THOSE EGGS, BORYS?



THAT — I DON'T KNOW. BUT SCIENTISTS ON EARTH WILL FIND OUT. IF WE GET THEM THERE.





I DON'T KNOW.

WHAT IS THAT?!

POLISHCHUK BORYS

HARRISON JOHN



HIS FINGERS TREMBLED. HE COULD NOT STOP THEM.

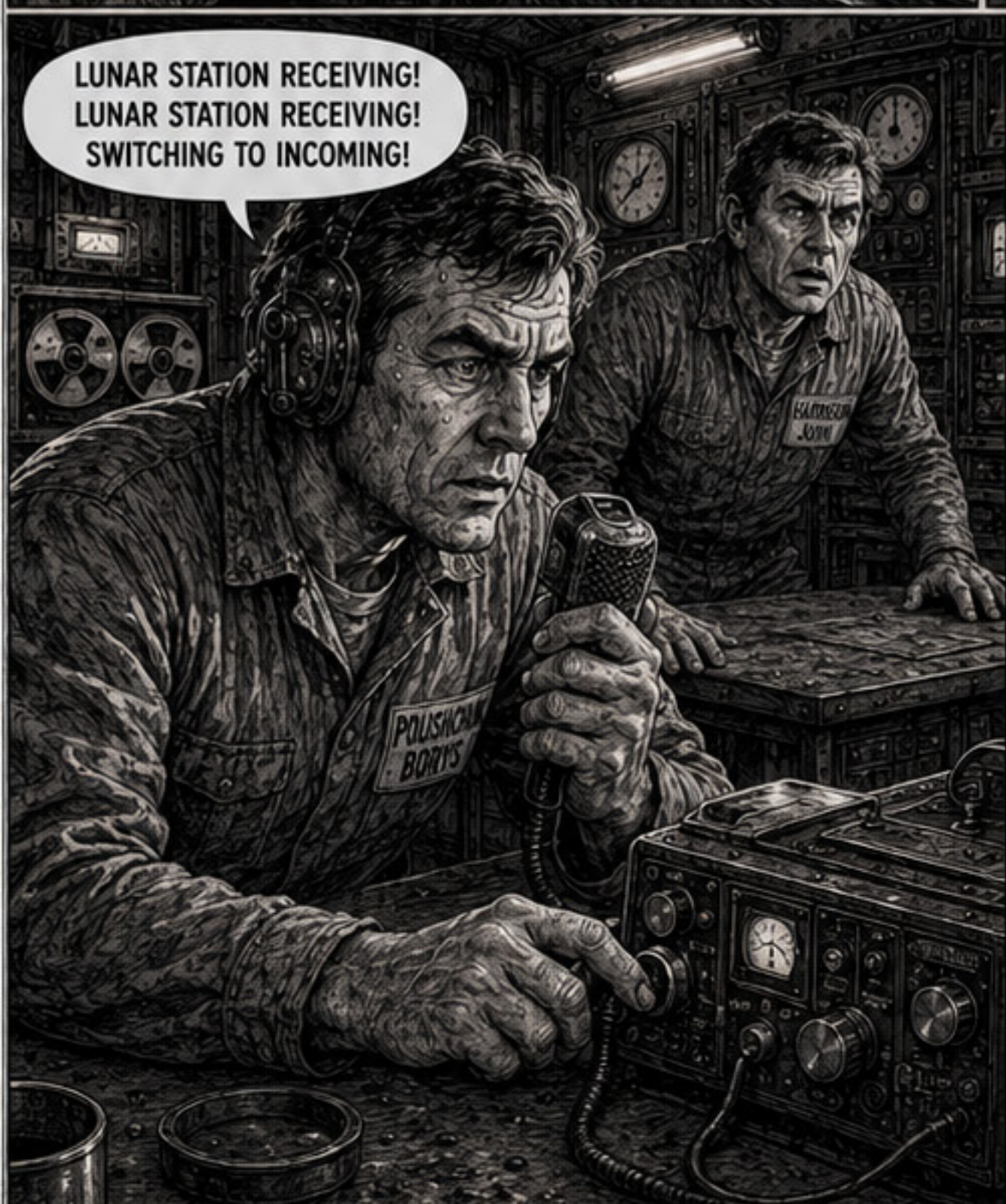


THE SOUND HIT THEM LIKE A PHYSICAL BLOW.

ЛУНА-17

HARRISON JOHN

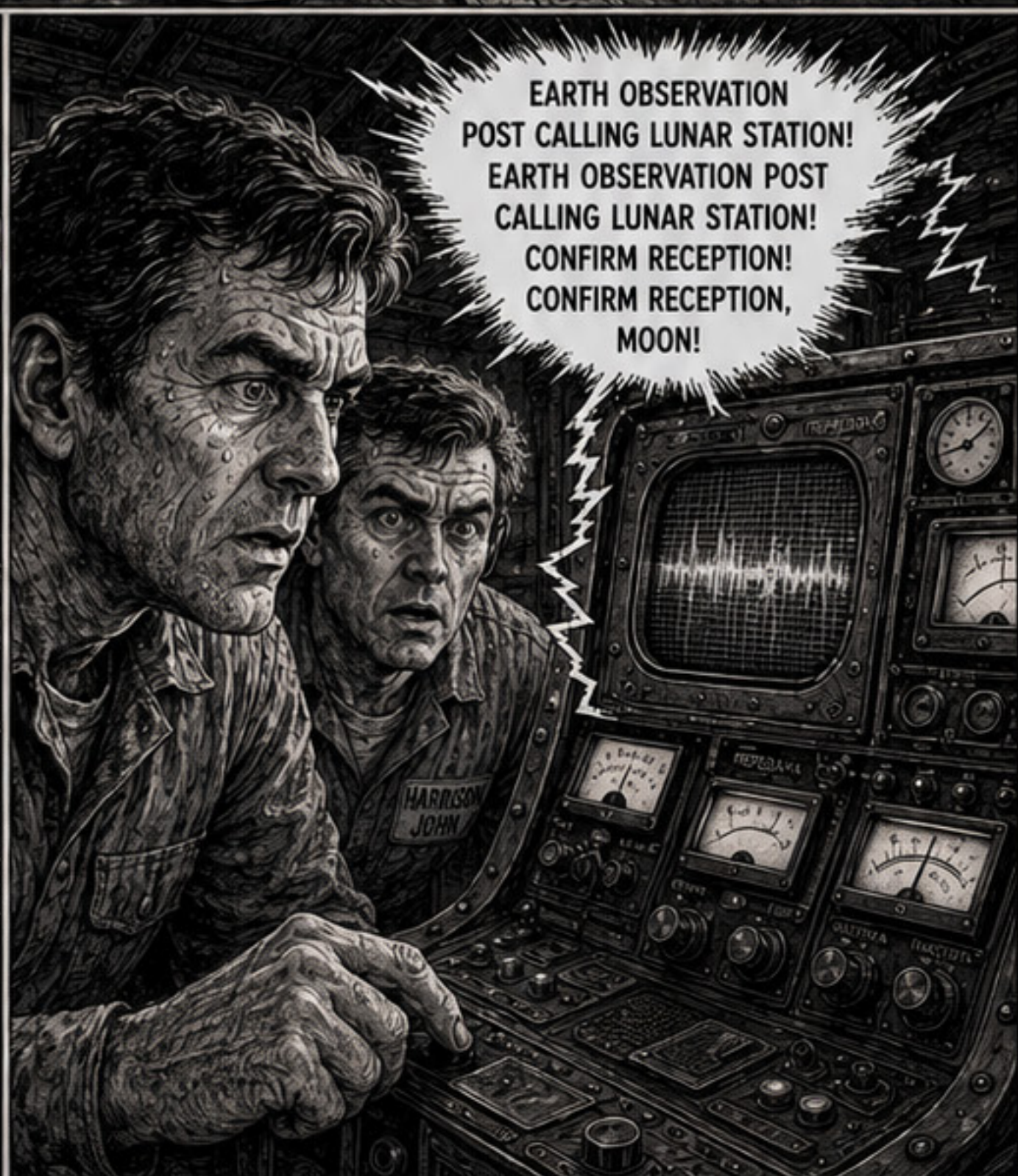
POLISHCHUK BORYS



LUNAR STATION RECEIVING!
LUNAR STATION RECEIVING!
SWITCHING TO INCOMING!

POLISHCHUK BORYS

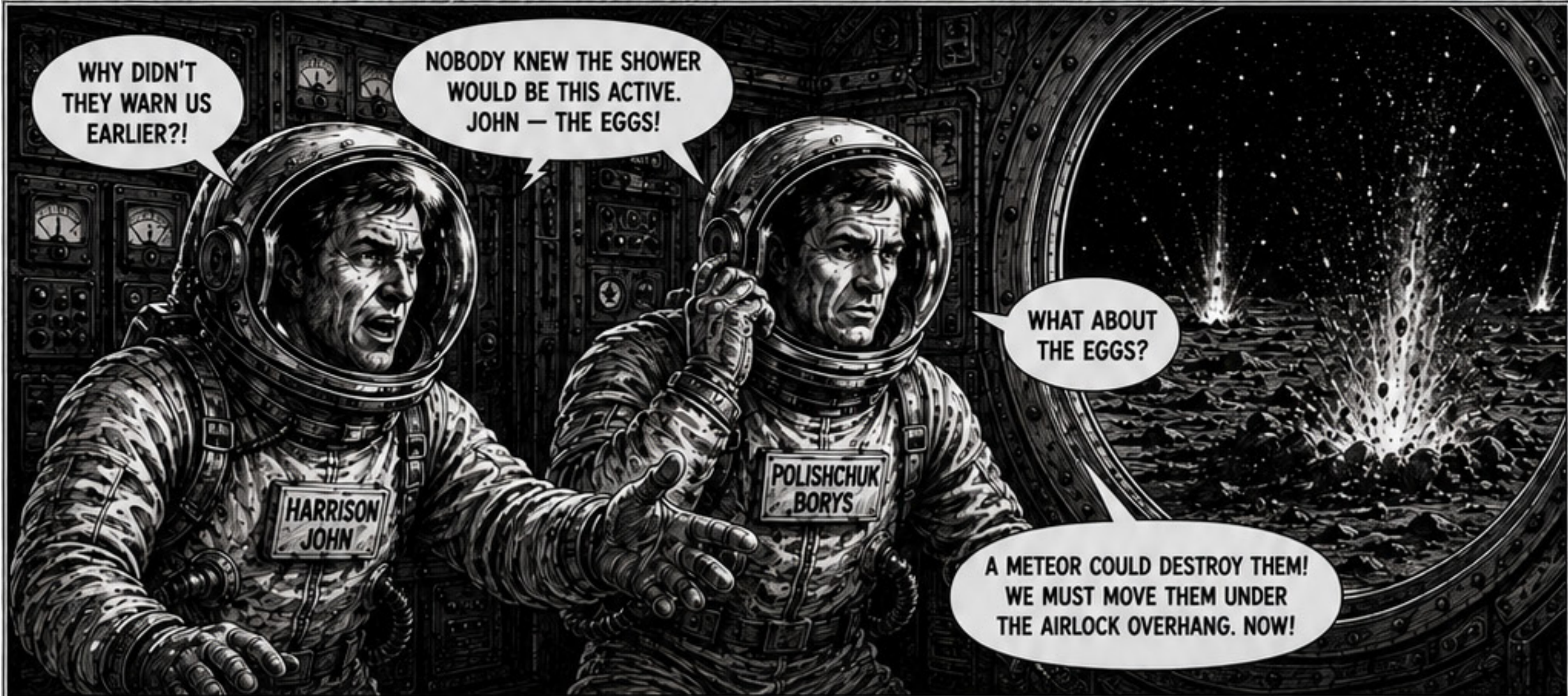
HARRISON JOHN



EARTH OBSERVATION POST CALLING LUNAR STATION!
EARTH OBSERVATION POST CALLING LUNAR STATION!
CONFIRM RECEPTION!
CONFIRM RECEPTION, MOON!

HARRISON JOHN





WHY DIDN'T
THEY WARN US
EARLIER?!

NOBODY KNEW THE SHOWER
WOULD BE THIS ACTIVE.
JOHN — THE EGGS!

WHAT ABOUT
THE EGGS?

A METEOR COULD DESTROY THEM!
WE MUST MOVE THEM UNDER
THE AIRLOCK OVERHANG. NOW!



HARRISON FOLLOWED.
THERE WAS NOTHING
ELSE TO DO.

WAIT, BORYS—!



THE MOON WAS
ALIVE WITH FIRE.



NO ATMOSPHERE. NO BURNING TRAILS.
JUST SILENT DEATH FROM ABOVE.



BORYS! THIS IS
TOO DANGEROUS,
BORYS!



1

HE FORGOT EVERYTHING.
EVEN HIS OWN LIFE.



2

THE EGGS WERE GONE.
ALL OF THEM.



3

ONE EGG.
BURIED UNDER SAND
AT THE CRATER'S EDGE.
ALIVE.



4

HARRISON'S VOICE
WARNED HIM.
HE DID NOT HEAR
A WORD.

BORYS!
THE METEORS!
GET TO COVER!
DO YOU HEAR ME?
BORYS!



5

ONLY FORWARD.
ONLY FORWARD.
TO THE BASE.



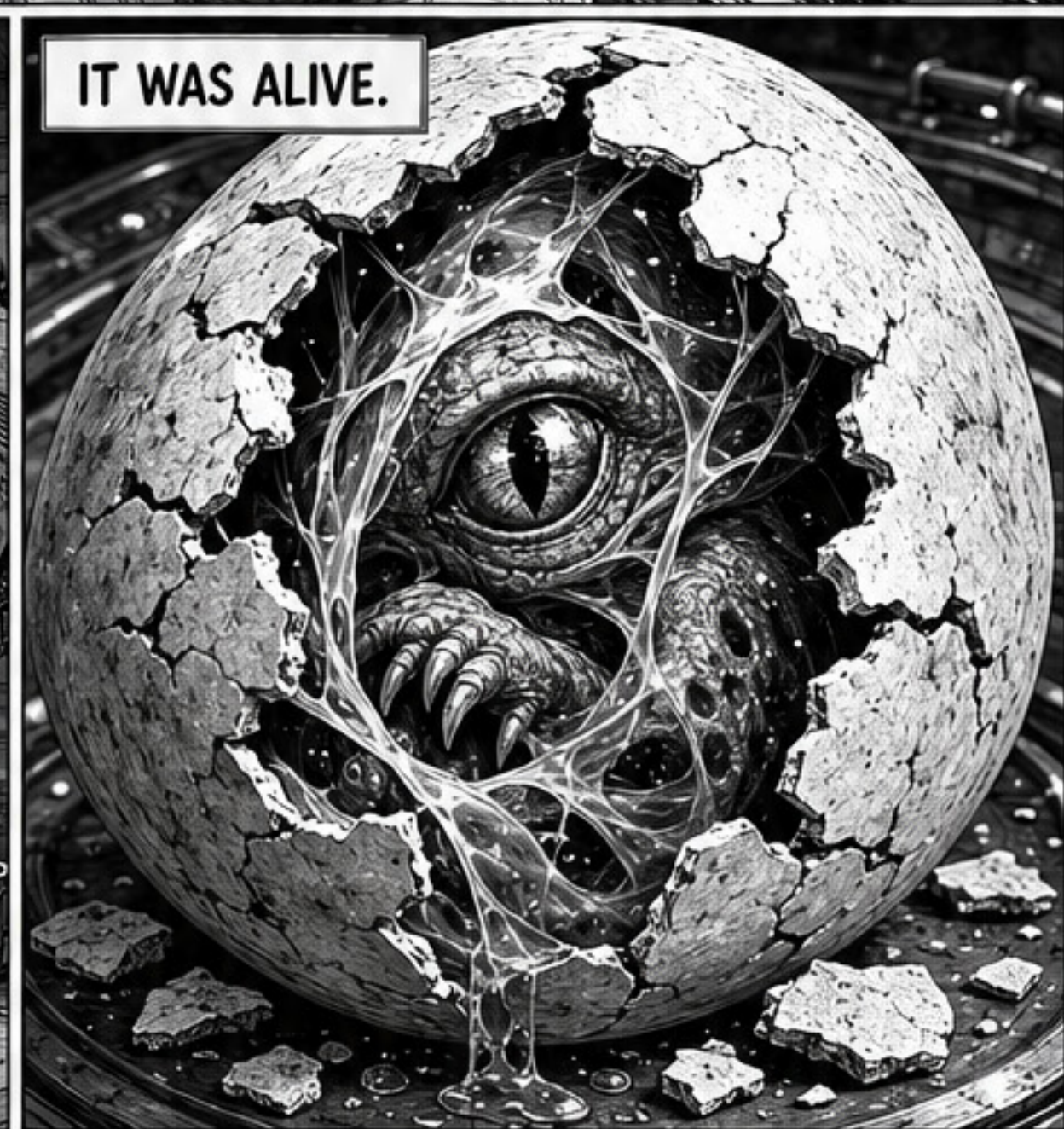
THEY COULDN'T
LEAVE IT OUT THERE.



THE SURFACE
TEMPERATURE IS
RISING.



IT WAS ALIVE.



UNDERSTOOD, JOHN.
SIX EARTH DAYS —
AND NOTHING YET.



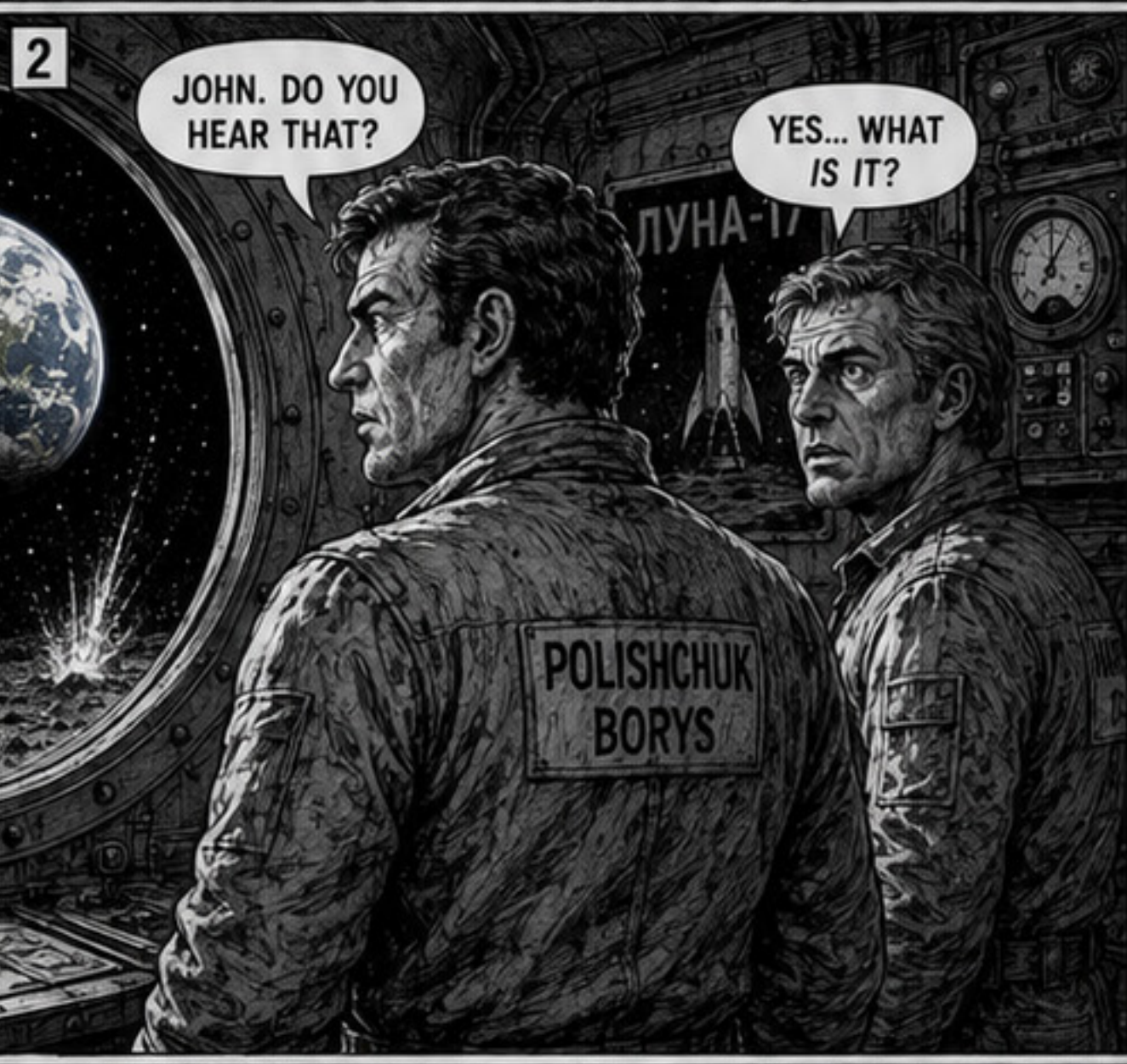
SURPRISES WILL COME
WHEN THEY COME...
JOHN — LOOK. EARTH.





1 EARTH. GLOWING GREEN IN THE BLACK SKY. FORESTS. MEADOWS. SEAS. SO FAR AWAY.

THE EASTERN HEMISPHERE...



2

JOHN. DO YOU HEAR THAT?

YES... WHAT IS IT?



3 THE KNOCKING DID NOT STOP. SOMETHING WAS TRYING TO OPEN THE DOOR.

HELMETS, JOHN!

ТОК!
ТОК!
ТОК!



4

IT'S... IT'S A SPAWN OF HELL...



5

NO. IT'S A PTERODACTYL.

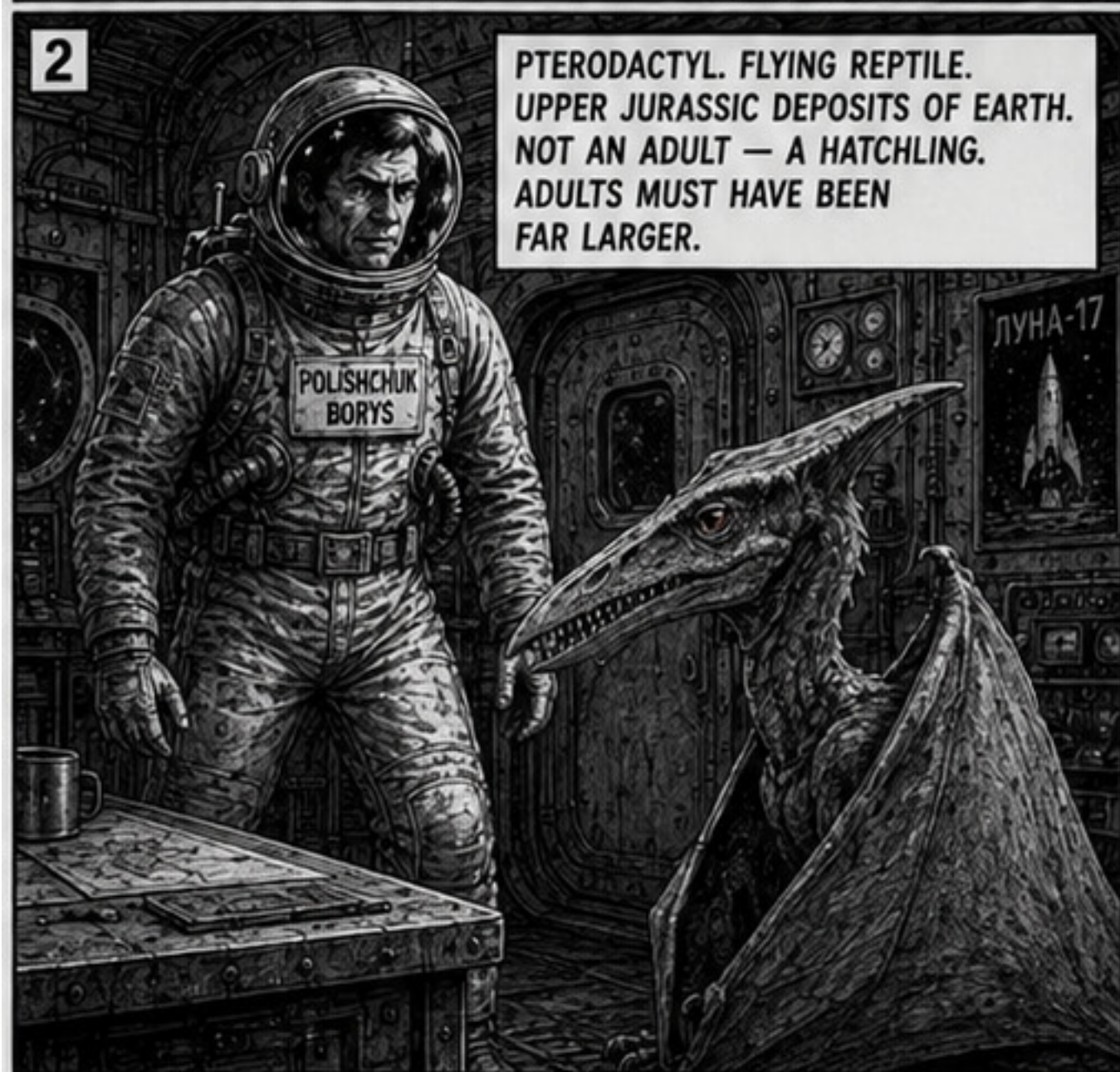
1

IT'S SOME TERRIBLE CHIMERA...
LIKE IN MEDIEVAL PAINTINGS!
I DID NOT COME HERE FOR THIS!



2

PTERODACTYL. FLYING REPTILE.
UPPER JURASSIC DEPOSITS OF EARTH.
NOT AN ADULT — A HATCHLING.
ADULTS MUST HAVE BEEN
FAR LARGER.



3

WHAT A FIERCE, PREDATORY GAZE
FOR SOMETHING SO SMALL.



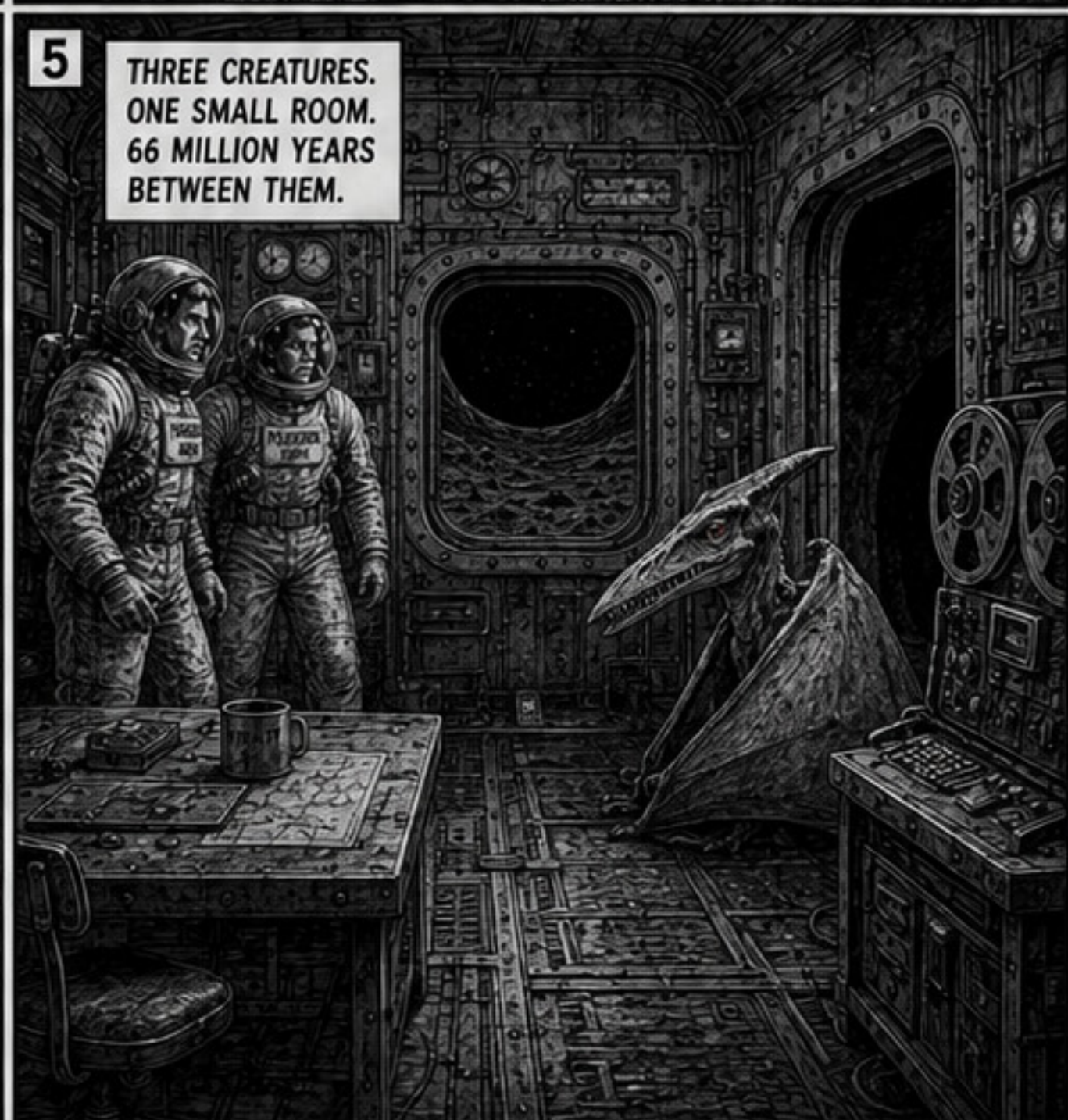
4

WE HAVE NO WEAPONS!
NOT EVEN A PISTOL!
IF THAT THING COMES AT US —
WHAT THEN?!



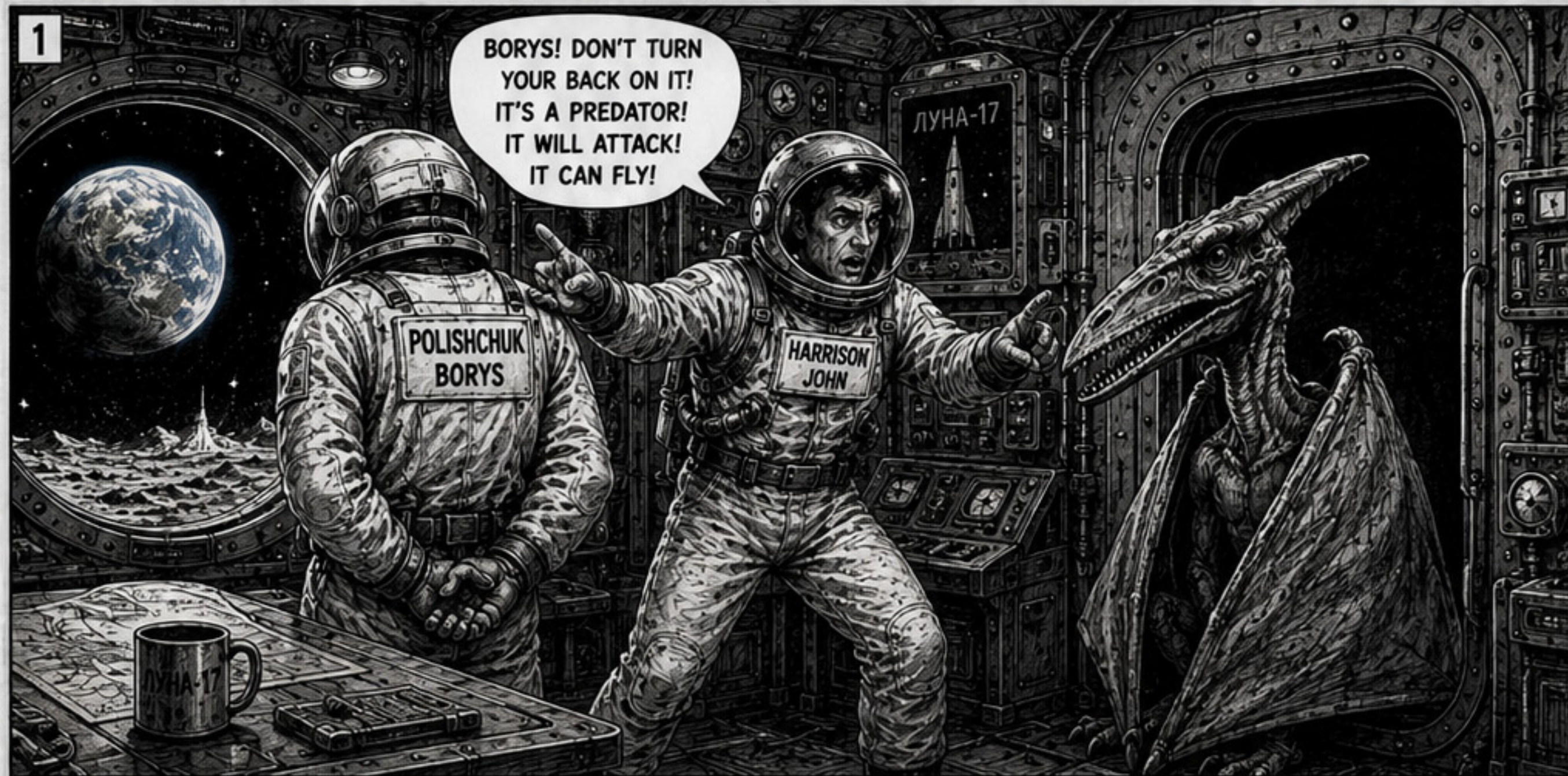
5

THREE CREATURES.
ONE SMALL ROOM.
66 MILLION YEARS
BETWEEN THEM.



1

BORYS! DON'T TURN
YOUR BACK ON IT!
IT'S A PREDATOR!
IT WILL ATTACK!
IT CAN FLY!



2

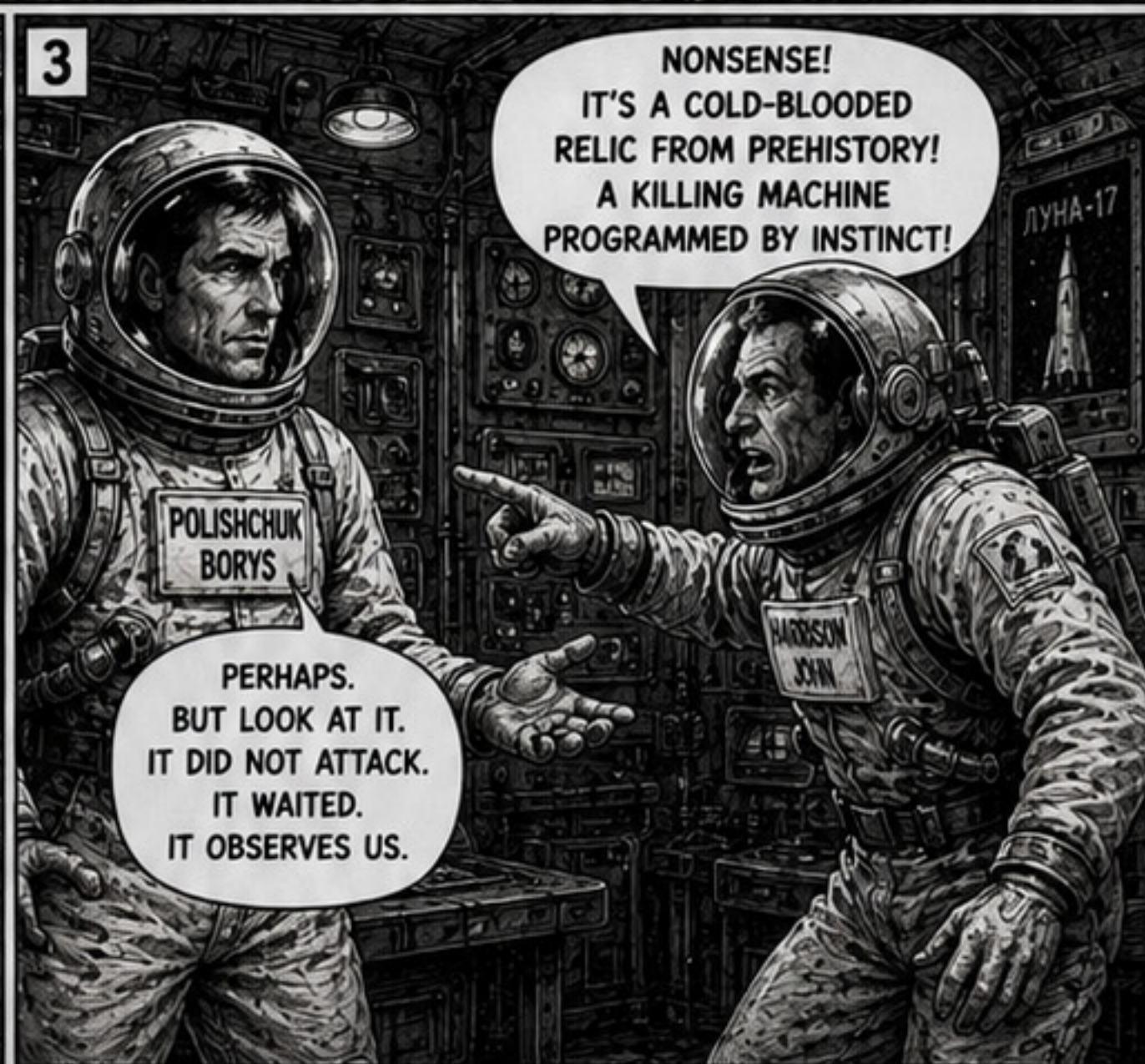
CALM DOWN, JOHN.
IT ISN'T AN ANIMAL.
NOT ANYMORE.
IT'S INTELLIGENT.
SENTIENT.
JUST LIKE US.



3

NONSENSE!
IT'S A COLD-BLOODED
RELIC FROM PREHISTORY!
A KILLING MACHINE
PROGRAMMED BY INSTINCT!

PERHAPS.
BUT LOOK AT IT.
IT DID NOT ATTACK.
IT WAITED.
IT OBSERVES US.



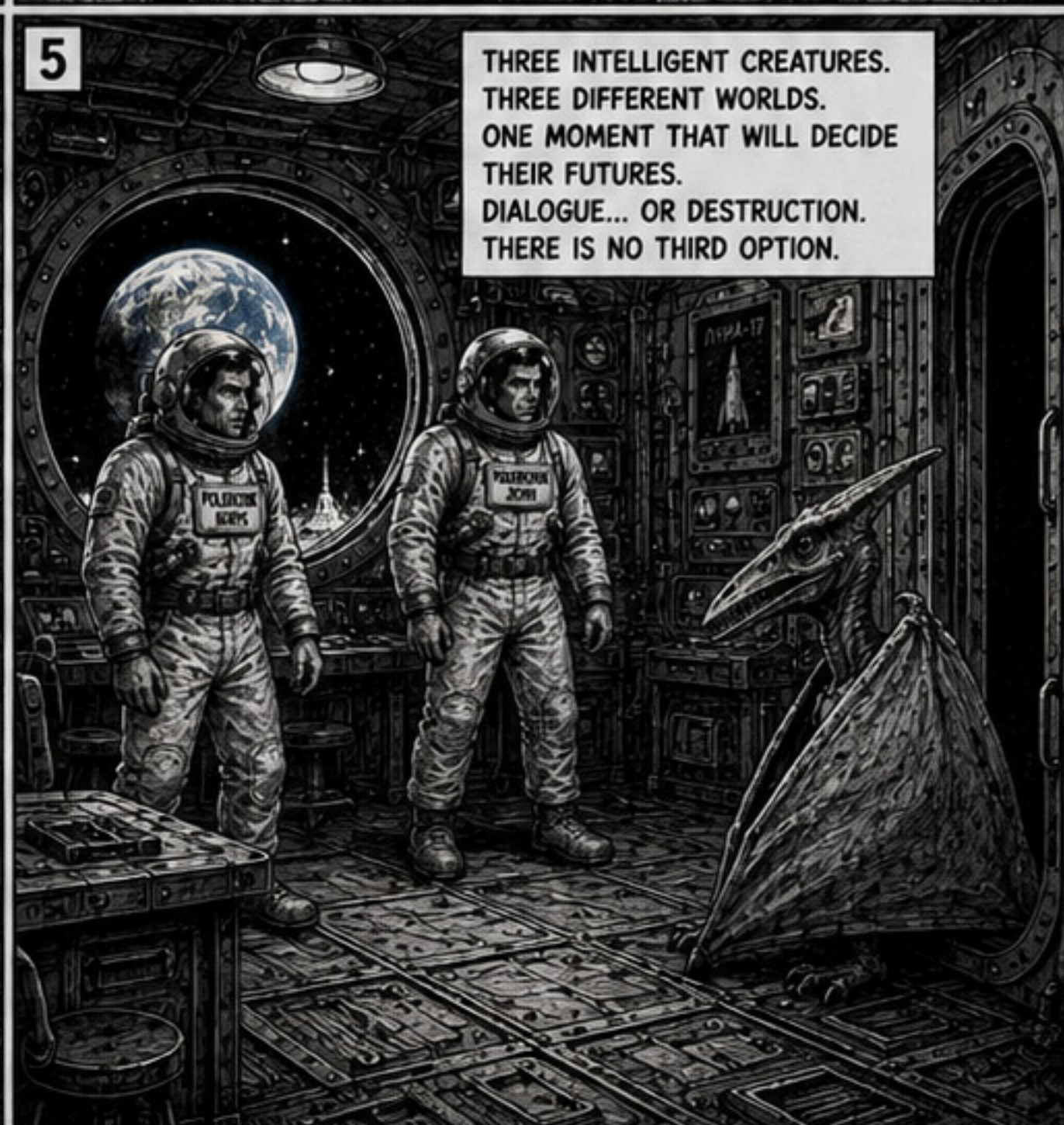
4

SIXTY-SIX MILLION YEARS
OF EVOLUTION.
AND NOW IT IS HERE.
WITH US.
PERHAPS NOT BY ACCIDENT.
PERHAPS WE WERE EXPECTED.



5

THREE INTELLIGENT CREATURES.
THREE DIFFERENT WORLDS.
ONE MOMENT THAT WILL DECIDE
THEIR FUTURES.
DIALOGUE... OR DESTRUCTION.
THERE IS NO THIRD OPTION.



THE WIND FROM ITS WINGS
STRUCK THEIR HELMETS
LIKE A HAMMER.

DEVIL!

FINALLY...

ЛУНА-17

CLOSE IT! WHILE IT
RESTS IN THE COLD!
WE CAN THINK LATER!

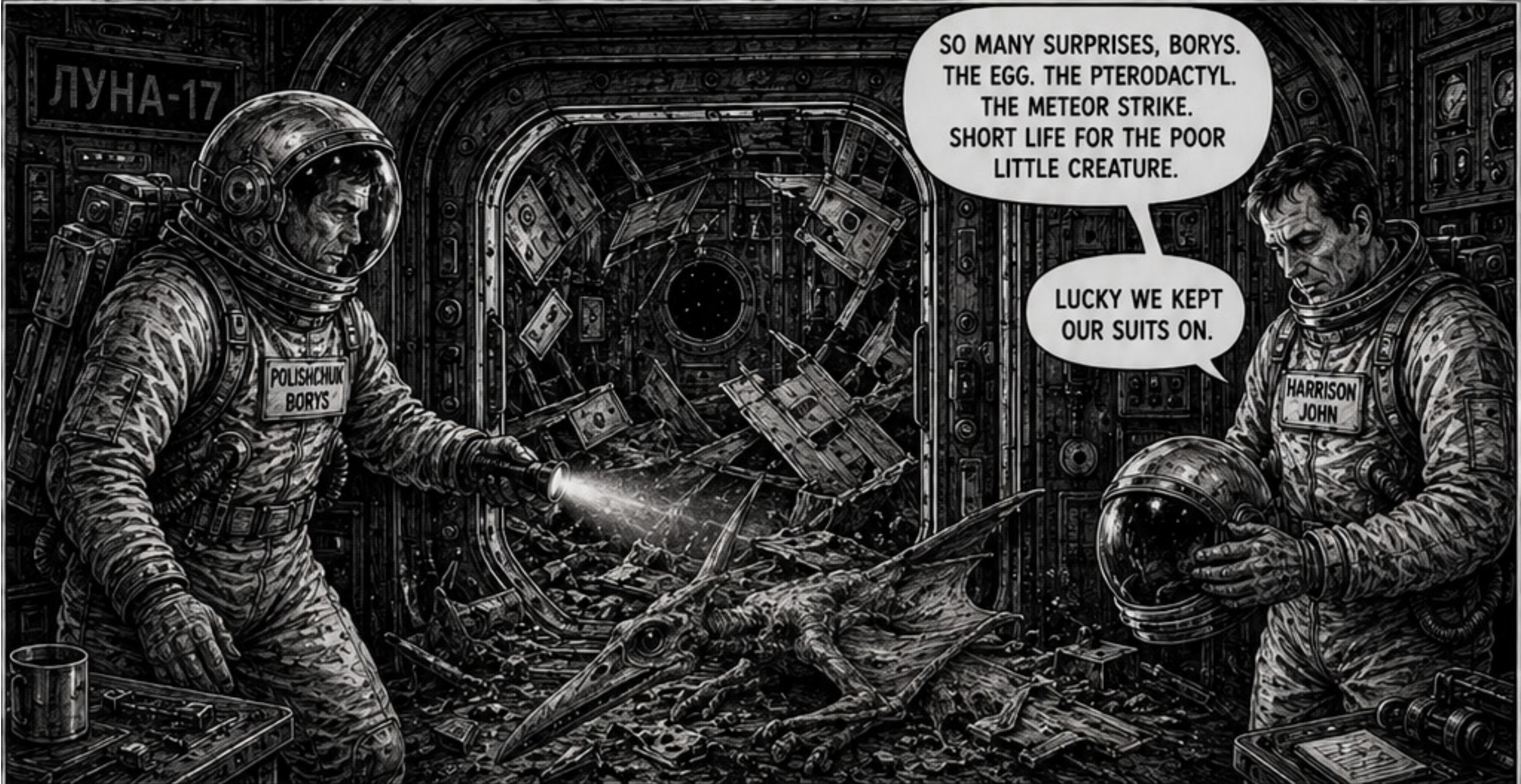
AND WHEN WE MUST
GO OUTSIDE AGAIN?

WITH METEORS FALLING—
WE CANNOT LEAVE ANYWAY.

A METEOR.
DIRECT HIT.

THE DOOR!
CLOSE THE DOOR!

THE CREATURE THAT SURVIVED
66 MILLION YEARS —
LIVED ONLY THREE HOURS
ON THE MOON.



Volodymyr Vladko: A Pioneer of Ukrainian Sci-Fi



Volodymyr Vladko

(real name **Yeremchenko**; January 8, 1901 – April 21, 1974) was a Ukrainian science fiction writer, journalist, theater critic, and translator.

He is widely regarded as one of the founding fathers of Ukrainian science fiction, often compared to Jules Verne. Vladko made his literary debut with the novella *The Robotars Are Coming* (Ідуть роботари, 1929), which earned him a prize at the All-Ukrainian Competition.

Key Publications

His subsequent major works include:

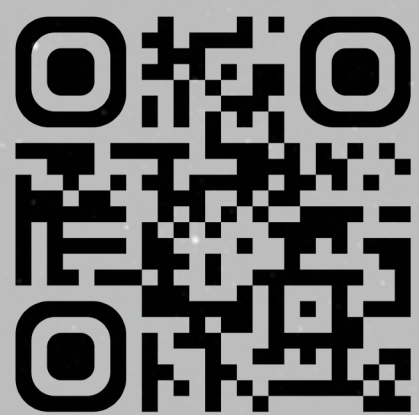
- The Aero-Torpedoes Turn Back (Аероторпеди повертають назад, 1934)
- The Miraculous Generator (Чудесний генератор, 1935)
- Argonauts of the Universe (Аргонавти Всесвіту, 1935; revised edition 1956)
- Twelve Short Stories (Дванадцять оповідань, 1936)
- Descendants of the Scythians (Нащадки скіфів, 1939)
- The Gray-Haired Captain (Сивий капітан, 1941)
- Borrowed Time (Позичений час, 1961)
- Magical Stories (Чарівні оповідання, 1962)
- The Purple Doom (Фіолетова загибель, 1963)

A Legacy of Foresight Volodymyr Vladko's sci-fi works were remarkably prophetic regarding technological progress. For instance, his novel *Argonauts of the Universe* provided such an accurate depiction of weightlessness in space that it later astonished the famous Ukrainian cosmonaut Pavlo Popovych.









For personal and
educational use only.
Not for sale.



Created with
ChatGPT Image GPT-4o &
Claude Sonnet 4.6



Based on the story by
Volodymyr Vladko (1955)



© All rights reserved

